LibanPost eShop

User Guide

A complete guide to using the platform — for shoppers, vendors (shop owners) and store staff. Written against the running application, so what is described here is what the software actually does.

Audience	Where to start
Shoppers (customers)	Part 1 — Shopping on the storefront
Vendors / shop owners	Part 2 — Running your shop
Store staff / administrators	Part 3 — Administering the store

Demo platform note: this is a fully working demonstration store. No real money moves and no real parcel is sent. Card payments run through a bundled simulator that behaves like a provider without being one. See “Known limitations” at the end.

Version: current (2026) · Generated from the application source.

Contents

Part 1 — Shopping on the storefront 4

1. Finding your way around 4
2. Browsing and searching 4
3. A product page 4
4. Your cart 5
5. Discount codes 5
6. Checkout 5
7. Paying for an order 5
8. Tracking an order 6
9. Your account 6
10. Wishlist 6
11. Reviews 6
12. Language 7
13. Shopper FAQ 7

Part 2 — Running your shop (vendors) 8

14. Opening a shop 8
15. Your dashboard 8
16. Listing products 8
    - Creating and editing a product 8
    - Image rules 8
17. Bulk-importing products 9
18. Orders 9
19. Reviews 9
20. Payouts and commission 10
21. Your storefront’s appearance 10
22. Vendor FAQ 11

Part 3 — Administering the store 12

23. The dashboard 12
24. Products 12
25. Bulk import 12
26. Categories 12
27. Inventory 12

28. Orders . . . 12
29. Customers . . . 13
30. Coupons . . . 13
31. Tax classes . . . 13
32. Shops . . . 14
33. Payouts . . . 14
34. Marketing analytics . . . 14
35. Reviews moderation . . . 14
36. Email outbox . . . 15
37. Exports . . . 15
38. The application log . . . 15
39. Admin FAQ . . . 16
40. Returning something (shoppers) . . . 16
41. Returns (vendors) . . . 17
42. Returns (administrators) . . . 17
43. Audit trail (administrators) . . . 17
44. Payout outcomes (administrators) . . . 18

Part 4 — Configuration and demo data . . . 19

Key settings (appsettings.json) . . . 19
Demo accounts . . . 19
Known limitations . . . 19
Support . . . 19

Part 1 — Shopping on the storefront

1. Finding your way around

The header is the same on every page.

What	Where it takes you
Search box	Type a few characters; matching products and departments appear beneath it. Press Enter or pick a suggestion.
All departments	Every category in the catalogue.
Shops	The shop directory — every seller on the marketplace.
Track an order	Look up an order without signing in.
Your cart	The basket, with a running item count.
My account	Your profile, orders, addresses and wishlist.

Signing in is optional. You can browse, fill a cart and check out as a guest; an account is only needed for order history, a wishlist, saved addresses and posting reviews.

2. Browsing and searching

The catalogue (`/Catalog`) shows every published product and is where all filtering happens. Search covers the product name, description, brand and SKU. Filters on offer:

Filter	Notes
Department	Includes sub-categories.
Price range	From and to.
Brand	Only brands that actually exist in the results are offered.
In stock only	Hides anything you could not buy today.
Minimum rating	Hides products below the star rating you choose.

Eight sort orders are available, including relevance (useful when you searched), top rated and most reviewed.

Every filter lives in the web address. The result set you are looking at can be bookmarked, shared or sent to yourself, and it will come back exactly as you left it.

Products that have been withdrawn or are still drafts never appear anywhere in the storefront.

3. A product page

A product page collects everything about one item:

- **Image gallery** — click a thumbnail to change the main image. Missing photographs show a placeholder.
- **Variants** — size, weight, colour or whatever the seller defined. Choose one before adding to the cart; the price and stock shown follow the variant you pick.
- **Stock messaging** — “in stock”, or a warning such as “Only 3 left” when it is running low.
- **Sale price** — a struck-through original price next to the current one when discounted.
- **Add to cart** and **wishlist** buttons.

- **Related products** — other items from the same seller or department.
- **Reviews** — the rating summary, a per-star breakdown, and every published review.

4. Your cart

The cart is the one place where the order's arithmetic is shown in full.

- Change the quantity or remove a line, and the totals update immediately.
- Per-line stock warnings appear if something in your basket has become unavailable or you asked for more than remains.
- A free-shipping hint tells you how far you are from the free-delivery threshold.
- The running total shows subtotal, shipping, tax and the amount due.

Tax is calculated per item, from each product's own tax class. In a basket holding both a standard-rated and a zero-rated item, each is taxed at its own rate — you are not charged one flat rate across the whole order.

Your cart is remembered between visits, and it survives signing in — items added as a guest are merged into your account rather than discarded.

5. Discount codes

Apply a code in the cart. One code at a time: entering a second replaces the first rather than stacking.

- The code is remembered, not the amount. The discount is recalculated against your current basket on every page view.
- If a code stops being valid — it expires, or reaches its limit, while sitting in your cart — it simply drops off with a notice.
- Every rule is re-checked when you place the order. What the order charges is decided server-side, never from what your browser last displayed.
- A discount is capped at the value of the goods it applies to, so a total can never go negative.

Seeded demo codes: `WELCOME10` (10% off, once per shopper), `POST5` ($5 off orders over $30) and `EXPIRED` (a code that no longer works, so you can see the rejection).

6. Checkout

Checkout is a single form:

1. **Contact** — name, email and optionally a phone number. The email is what the order confirmation is sent to.
2. **Delivery address** — fill it in, or pick one you have saved. Tick a box to save a new address to your address book.
3. **Payment** — cash on delivery, or card if a card gateway is configured.
4. **Review** the order summary, then **place the order**.

Placing an order is idempotent: if your connection stutters and the form is submitted twice, you get one order, not two.

7. Paying for an order

Cash on delivery is the default. Nothing is taken up front; you pay when the parcel reaches you.

When a card gateway is configured, **card** is offered as well. Choosing it sends you to the provider's own payment page, and the order is confirmed by the provider telling the store the payment succeeded — not by your browser reporting it. That distinction is what makes it safe: closing the tab or losing signal mid-payment cannot mark an order paid.

If a card payment is declined, the order is **not** failed. It stays pending and you are offered a link to try again — the same order is captured when a later attempt succeeds.

On the demonstration store, the card option runs through a **simulator** that signs and verifies its own messages exactly as a real provider would. It moves no money.

8. Tracking an order

Two ways, and neither needs the other:

- **Signed in** — *My orders* lists your history, and each order opens onto its detail page with a status timeline.
- **As a guest** — *Track an order* takes your order number and the email you used, and shows the same status without an account.

An order moves through these states:

```
Pending → Paid → Shipped → Delivered (also: Cancelled, Refunded)
```

Only legal moves are allowed — a cancelled order cannot quietly become delivered.

9. Your account

Register or sign in from the header. An account gives you:

- **Order history** and order detail.
- **A wishlist.**
- **An address book** — as many addresses as you like, one marked as the default, editable and removable.
- **Profile and password change.**
- **Password reset by email** if you forget it. The reset link works exactly once and expires; the request page always reports success.

Passwords are stored using PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA256 with 210,000 iterations. Repeated failed sign-ins lock the account for a short window, and a wrong password never reveals whether the account exists.

10. Wishlist

Save a product from its page with the wishlist button; it is stored against your account and listed at your wishlist page. Press the button again to remove it.

11. Reviews

Reviews exist to help the next shopper, so they are tied to real purchases.

- **Who may review** — you must be signed in and have a paid, shipped or delivered order line for that product. A verified-purchase badge is decided by the store from your order history.
- **One review per shopper per product.** After you post one, the form becomes an edit form.
- **Reviews publish immediately.** Moderation exists to remove the minority that break the rules.

- **Vote helpful or not helpful** on someone else's review. One vote each; vote again to change your mind.
- **Sellers may reply once** under a review, publicly.

Product scores and shop scores are calculated from published reviews every time they are shown, so a score can never drift away from the reviews behind it.

12. Language

The store is available in English, Arabic and French. The switcher is in the top bar.

- Your choice is remembered on your device.
- If you have not chosen, the store follows your browser's preference, then falls back to English.
- Arabic renders right-to-left, and the layout mirrors with it.

At present the chrome — navigation, cart, checkout, account and footer labels — is translated. Product names, descriptions and some deeper screens are still English only.

13. Shopper FAQ

Question	Answer
Do I need an account to buy?	No. Check out as a guest. An account is needed for history, wishlist, saved addresses and reviews.
Why did my discount code disappear?	It stopped being valid — expired or reached its limit. The store re-checks on every page.
Why can I not add this item?	Pick a variant first. A product with options cannot be added until one is chosen.
Why is the item in my cart now out of stock?	Stock is reserved at order placement, not at add-to-cart. The cart tells you which line is affected.
My payment was declined — did I lose the order?	No. The order stays pending with a failed attempt; a retry link is offered.
Can I use two discount codes together?	No. One code per order; a second replaces the first.
Can I change or cancel an order?	Cancelling is a staff action. Contact the store; stock is restored on cancellation.

Part 2 — Running your shop (vendors)

14. Opening a shop

Your workspace lives at `/Vendor`. On first visit, if you do not yet have a shop, you are sent to the registration form (`/Vendor/Onboarding/Register`) for your shop's name, contact details and branding.

Once submitted, the shop is **pending** until a staff member approves it at `/Admin/Shops`. On approval your shop appears in the storefront's shop directory and your products can be published. Staff also set your commission rate at that point.

If a shop is ever suspended, you keep your data and your workspace; only the public storefront stops showing you.

15. Your dashboard

The dashboard (`/Vendor/Dashboard`) answers "how is my shop doing right now?" at a glance:

- Key figures — products, orders, gross sales, and the amount currently owed to you.
- A 30-day revenue trend and daily figures.
- Best-selling products by revenue and by units.
- Sales by payment method.
- Low-stock alerts — what needs restocking before it sells out.
- Recent orders, linking straight into the order detail.

Every figure is scoped to your shop only. A brand-new shop shows an honest empty state.

16. Listing products

Products (`/Vendor/Products`) is your catalogue, scoped to your own shop. You can search it, filter by category and state (active, draft, out of stock, deleted), and sort.

Creating and editing a product

- **Name and slug** — the slug is what appears in the web address. Leave it blank and it is derived from the name; kept unique within your shop.
- **Category** — chosen from the marketplace's category tree (shared across all sellers).
- **Brand**, **short description** and **full description**.
- **Variants** — the matrix of options you actually sell. Each has its own SKU, price, optional compare-at price (for a struck-through sale price) and stock quantity. A product with no options still has one variant, usually named *Default*.
- **Images** — either typed URLs or uploaded files; you can mix the two.
- **Published** — a draft is invisible on the storefront. **Featured** surfaces a product in the storefront's featured strip.

You can soft-delete a product, which hides it without destroying the order history that refers to it, and restore it later.

Image rules

- Allowed types: JPEG, PNG, GIF and WebP. The file's actual leading bytes must match its extension.
- SVG is deliberately not accepted, because an SVG is a document that can carry a script.
- Per-file size limit 5 MB; gallery limit 10 images per product.

- The first image is the primary one — the order in the list is the order in the gallery.
- A bad upload fails the whole save rather than being silently dropped, and any file written during that failed attempt is cleaned up.
- Removing an image URL deletes the stored file, unless another product still points at the same URL.

17. Bulk-importing products

Bulk import is currently a **staff** tool at `/Admin/Import`. Vendors cannot reach it directly; ask staff to run an import against your shop, or add products through the editor.

The importer takes a CSV whose columns are matched by name, so column order does not matter. Only `Name`, `Price` and `SKU` are required. Full header:

```
Name,Slug,Category,Brand,ShortDescription,Description,SKU,VariantName,Price,Compare
AtPrice,StockQuantity,IsPublished,IsFeatured,Images
```

- `SKU` is the key. An existing product is matched by SKU first, then slug, then name.
- `Category` must already exist, matched case-insensitively.
- `Images` is a semicolon-separated list of URLs; the first becomes the primary image. Omitting the column entirely leaves the existing gallery untouched.
- An import is all-or-nothing. Every row is validated before anything is written; one bad row rejects the whole file and reports the line.
- `IsPublished` accepts `true`/`yes`/`1`. Prices use a decimal point regardless of your machine's locale.

18. Orders

Your order book is at `/Vendor/Orders`.

- Filter by status, or search by order number, customer name or email.
- Open an order to see its items, delivery address, customer contact, totals, payment method, collection status and tracking number.

Your orders only. An order belonging to another shop returns a not-found page. Order status is changed by staff, not by vendors. If you need an order cancelled or refunded, contact the store.

19. Reviews

Reviews (`/Vendor/Reviews`) shows every review left against your products, along with:

- Your aggregate score across all published reviews.
- Your reputation badge, earned from that score.
- A reply box under each review.

You may post one public reply per review, and edit or clear it afterwards. The rating and the wording belong to the customer.

Badge	Threshold
Star seller	average 4.2 or better over 5 or more reviews
Top rated seller	average 4.5 or better over 15 or more reviews

A shop that does not yet meet either threshold shows no badge. The exact numbers are configuration, not code. Badges appear in the shop directory, on your storefront and in your workspace.

20. Payouts and commission

Your money page is `/Vendor/Payouts`. It is read-only — you see exactly what you are owed and what has been paid, and you cannot settle yourself. Staff make settlements from the admin area.

- The marketplace holds the shopper's money and owes you your share.
- Commission is withheld at the gate, on goods only — never on the shipping the carrier keeps. It is rounded half-away-from-zero to the cent.
- You are credited when the money is actually collected: a card order on capture, a cash-on-delivery order at delivery, a counter payment when staff mark it paid.
- A cancellation or refund reverses the credit.
- Crediting happens exactly once — a redelivered payment message cannot pay you twice.

What you are owed is never a stored number. Your balance is always the sum of your unsettled earnings, so it cannot drift away from the orders and refunds behind it. A settlement merely marks the earnings it covers as settled and gives you a statement — reference, period, and the gross, commission and net figures — downloadable as CSV or Excel.

One edge case: if a refund lands after a settlement has already paid you, your balance goes negative and stays negative until new sales cover it. That is the correct accounting, not an error.

21. Your storefront's appearance

Every shop gets its own themed storefront. Choose the template at `/Vendor/Appearance`. Six templates are available, each previewed live:

Template	Character
Postal Classic	The house palette — blue and yellow. The default.
Midnight	Dark.
Sunrise	Warm and light.
Boutique	Elegant, with serif headings.
Forest	Natural, green.
Mono	Minimal, black and white.

Changing the template re-skins the whole storefront — header, product cards, buttons and footer — without touching a single product. A template that is somehow unknown falls back to the default.

22. Vendor FAQ

Question	Answer
How do I become a vendor?	Register a shop at /Vendor/Onboarding/Register; staff approve it and set your commission.
My product is saved but not visible.	Check it is published, has a variant with stock, and your shop is approved.
Why can I not change an order’s status?	Status changes are staff-only. Ask the store.
Why has my balance not been paid?	Money may not be collected yet, or the balance is below the minimum, or it is negative after a refund.
Why does my balance show less than my sales?	Commission is withheld, on goods only.
Can I edit or delete a customer’s review?	No. You may post one public reply.
Can I see another shop’s orders?	No. Your workspace is scoped to your own shop.
My imported file was rejected and nothing changed.	Imports are all-or-nothing. Fix the listed lines and re-upload.

Part 3 — Administering the store

23. The dashboard

`/Admin/Dashboard` is the operational summary: revenue (lifetime and the last 30 days), order counts by state, the value of stock on hand, and stock alerts for anything at or below its low-stock threshold. It is the “is anything on fire?” page; the Marketing page is the “how are we doing?” page.

24. Products

`/Admin/Products` is the catalogue. It offers search, category and state filters (active, draft, out of stock, deleted), and the same editor a vendor uses — full variant matrix, image gallery that takes typed URLs and uploaded files, publish toggle, and soft delete with restore.

Staff differ from vendors in one way that matters: staff see the whole catalogue and the soft-deleted rows, so a withdrawn product can be found and restored.

Because orders snapshot the product name, variant name, SKU and unit price onto each order line, editing or deleting a product never rewrites the history of an order that already contains it.

25. Bulk import

`/Admin/Import` loads a CSV of products into a chosen shop. All-or-nothing, validates every row before writing anything, and reports failures by line number. Column order does not matter; headers are matched by name. `Name`, `Price` and `SKU` are required.

The importer is the exact inverse of the store’s CSV export, so you can export products, edit them in a spreadsheet, and import the file straight back.

- Matching is by SKU, then slug, then name.
- `Category` must already exist.
- Omitting the `Images` column leaves the existing gallery untouched; supplying it replaces the gallery.
- Turning off “create products that do not exist yet” makes it an update-only import.

26. Categories

`/Admin/Categories` manages the catalogue’s tree with indentation and per-category product counts. Categories are global to the marketplace, shared across every shop. The form guards against cycles — you cannot make a category its own ancestor.

27. Inventory

`/Admin/Inventory` shows stock levels across products and lets you adjust them. Every change is written to an append-only stock-movement ledger, so any movement can be explained after the fact.

Stock is committed under optimistic concurrency. If two customers check out the last item at the same instant, one gets a conflict rather than both being sold something that does not exist; the order service retries with a fresh basket and, if it still cannot be filled, tells the customer plainly.

28. Orders

`/Admin/Orders` is the fulfilment queue.

- Filter by status and search by customer or order number.
- Open an order for its detail: lines, addresses, payment, collection status and tracking.

- Change status with `UpdateStatus`, subject to the order state machine — only legal transitions are permitted.

Transition	Effect
→ Paid	Credits the vendor ledger (money collected).
→ Shipped	Queues a shipping notification email, with tracking.
→ Cancelled	Restores stock and reverses the vendor's earning.
→ Refunded	Calls the payment gateway; reverses the vendor's earning. Stock is not restored.

Export the current filter selection as CSV or Excel.

29. Customers

`/Admin/Customers` searches accounts and shows a detail page with lifetime spend. Accounts can be activated or deactivated — a deactivated account cannot sign in, but its order history stays intact. Deactivating is preferred over deleting.

30. Coupons

`/Admin/Coupons` creates and edits discount codes:

- Type — percentage or fixed amount.
- Minimum subtotal, and a validity window (starts / expires).
- `MaxUses` (global) and `MaxUsesPerUser` (per shopper).
- Optional restriction to one shop.
- An activate toggle.

Validation refuses nonsense at the form: a percentage over 100, an out-of-range fixed amount, a start after the expiry, and a shop-scoped code with no shop are all rejected.

A code that has already been redeemed is deactivated rather than deleted, so order history stays honest. Every redemption is recorded as a `CouponUsage` row holding the user and the order — which is how the per-shopper cap is enforced without trusting the browser.

Coupons do not stack, and they are not line-item aware — one code per order, applied to the goods subtotal.

31. Tax classes

`/Admin/Tax` defines named tax rates. A product may point at one; a product with no class is taxed at the store-wide rate (`Store:TaxRate`).

- Rates are entered as a fraction: `0.11` means eleven percent. The form refuses anything outside 0–1.
- A class can be marked exempt — always zero, whatever the rate says.
- Deleting is guarded: if products still reference a class, it is deactivated rather than deleted, because deleting it would silently move those products onto the store rate.
- The page shows how many live products are on each class and how many are on the store default.

Tax is applied per line, from each line's own class, with any order-level discount apportioned across the lines first. Products with no tax class behave exactly as they did before this feature existed — the store rate applies, unchanged. A fresh store is seeded with one *Standard rate* class and leaves products

unassigned.

Export the class list as CSV or Excel.

32. Shops

`/Admin/Shops` is where the marketplace's sellers are governed:

Action	Meaning
Approve	The shop goes live and appears in the directory. Also where you set its commission rate.
Reject	Declines a pending application.
Suspend	Takes a live shop off the storefront, keeping its data and workspace.
Reinstate	Puts a suspended shop back.

Commission is entered as a percentage in the form (`10` = 10%); the store divides by 100. Commission is withheld on goods only, never on shipping.

33. Payouts

`/Admin/Payouts` is where vendor money is settled.

- The list shows every shop's outstanding balance — gross, commission withheld, and net.
- Pay out settles the whole balance in one action, producing a statement.
- A statement, and the settlement history, can be downloaded as CSV or Excel.

The vendor's balance is derived — always the sum of their unsettled ledger entries, never a stored figure that could drift. A settlement marks those entries as settled and records a reference and period; it does not write new earnings. A payout is recorded, not transferred — there is no banking integration. A balance below `Payouts:MinimumAmount` is not settled. If a refund lands after a settlement, the shop's balance goes negative.

34. Marketing analytics

`/Admin/Marketing` answers "how are we doing?" — revenue over time, top products by revenue and by units, revenue by category, best customers, payment-method mix, coupon performance and fast-moving stock.

Every section exports as CSV or Excel, through the same eight section names the page presents: `daily-revenue`, `top-products-revenue`, `top-products-units`, `revenue-by-category`, `top-customers`, `payment-methods`, `coupons`, `fast-moving`.

- Only collected money counts as revenue. A pending, cancelled or refunded order is not revenue.
- Coupon performance reports the discount checkout actually applied, read from the order itself, not reconstructed from the coupon's rules.

35. Reviews moderation

`/Admin/Reviews` is the moderation queue, filterable by state (pending / published / rejected) and by star rating.

Reviews publish immediately by default. The queue is reactive — it exists to hide the minority that break the rules, not to gate every review. From here you can publish, hide, return to the queue, or delete

outright. Seller replies are not moderated in the queue.

36. Email outbox

`/Admin/Emails` is the transactional outbox: every message the store intended to send, including the ones that failed.

- Filter by state (queued, sent, failed, skipped) and by type.
- Open a message for a rendered preview of what the customer receives.
- Resend a failed message, which returns it to the queue with a clean history.
- Send a test message to confirm configuration.
- Nothing sends on the request path. A checkout queues a row and returns; a background dispatcher delivers it.
- Messages are idempotent by a dedupe key, so a retried request cannot send the same notification twice.
- Failures retry with backoff, then park as Failed with the full error preserved.
- With `Email:Enabled = false`, messages are recorded as Skipped rather than dropped.
- The default transport writes real `.eml` and `.html` files instead of sending, so email works with no mail server.

37. Exports

Orders, products, customers, payouts, tax classes and every marketing section export as CSV or Excel.

- The export runs the same query the page does, so the file and the screen cannot disagree.
- CSV is UTF-8 with a byte-order mark, so Excel reads Arabic and accented names correctly.
- A cell beginning `=`, `+`, `-` or `@` is prefixed with an apostrophe, so a customer whose name starts with `=` cannot smuggle a formula into your spreadsheet.
- The Excel output is a real workbook: numbers Excel can sum, real dates, a bold frozen header row and an autofilter.
- Exports are capped (orders 200, products 5,000) to match the page and bound memory.

38. The application log

Everything the application logs goes to the console and to the `Log` table in the configured database. The console is gone when the window closes; the table is what a deployment keeps.

```
SELECT TOP 50 Id, Logged, Level, Logger, Message FROM [Log] ORDER BY Id DESC;
```

`Error` and `Critical` rows carry the full exception and stack trace. A logging call can never fail, block or throw a request — callers enqueue, and a background writer batches the insert. Retention is off by default, so the table grows until retention is configured.

39. Admin FAQ

Question	Answer
I changed a product's price — why do old orders still show the old price?	Order lines snapshot at sale time. Editing a product cannot rewrite history.
Why can't I delete this tax class?	Products still reference it. The page deactivated it instead; reassign the products, then delete.
Why is a coupon still listed after it was used up?	A redeemed coupon is deactivated rather than deleted. It will not apply.
Why did the vendor's balance go negative?	A refund landed after a settlement had already paid them. New sales will cover it.
Why does marketing revenue differ from the order list total?	Marketing counts only collected money.
Do coupon discounts show the right figure?	Yes — read from the order, not recalculated from the coupon's rules.
A bulk import failed — did it write anything?	No. All-or-nothing; errors are listed by line.
Why is a customer's order missing from their history?	It may have been placed as a guest with an email not tied to an account.

40. Returning something (shoppers)

When a purchase does not work out you can send it back. The flow is the same for every shop:

- Ask - open the order on My orders and press Request a return. The form lists every line with the units you may still return (units an earlier return already refunded are gone) and a box for the reason. You get an RMA number such as RMA-2026-0001.
- The shop decides - it approves or rejects the request, with a note. Both outcomes email you.
- The goods go back - once approved, hand the parcel back. The shop records it as received; anything returned goes back on their shelf.
- The refund - issued by store staff. The maths is deliberately simple: the price of what you return (your share of any discount included) plus the proportionate tax. Shipping is refunded only when the whole order goes back. Part of an order can be returned; the order page keeps its running total of what has been refunded so far.

Statuses on the order page:

Requested -> Approved -> Received -> Refunded (or) Rejected

- You can cancel a return yourself at any point before it is received, by pressing Cancel request on the order page.
- An order may hold only one open return at a time; once one is settled you can raise another.
- Guest checkouts cannot raise returns - sign in first so the shop knows who you are.
- A full return also moves the order to Refunded and flips a cash-on-delivery collection to refunded.

41. Returns (vendors)

When a shopper asks to send something back, it arrives on your worklist at /Vendor/Returns - Open only shows what needs a decision today. A return for another shop's order is invisible; opening one by typing its id gives a not-found page.

- Decide - open the RMA and approve or reject it, with a note the shopper sees. A rejection needs a reason.
- Receive - when the parcel returns, press Record goods received. The units go straight back onto the shelf of your listing (or the shared variant stock if the listing was withdrawn), with a return-stamped entry in the stock ledger.
- The customer cannot raise a second open return on the same order, and units a completed return already refunded cannot be asked back again - the form enforces that, and the server enforces it too.

What you deliberately cannot see or do from this page: the refund itself. Only store staff move money. Every decision you make is recorded on the store's audit trail with your name on it.

42. Returns (administrators)

/Admin/Returns is the marketplace's RMA desk. Shops decide their own returns day to day, but staff can act for them and are the only role that issues the actual refund.

- The queue - filter by status, or search by RMA reference, shopper email or order number. Counters above the table show how many sit at requested, approved and received. Export the current view as CSV or Excel.
- Deciding - a return can be approved or rejected from here, with a note, exactly as the vendor would.
- Receiving - goods received restocks the returned units into the shop's listing stock (or the shared variant pool) and writes a return-stamped stock movement.
- Refunding - press Issue refund on a received return. The amount is computed, not typed: the goods actually returned (with their share of any order discount) plus the proportionate tax, shipping only when the whole order comes back. It is capped by whatever the ledger still owes the shop for that sale and by GrandTotal minus RefundedTotal. A card refund goes back against the original charge; a cash-on-delivery refund is a staff bookkeeping row.

A refund that cannot go through (no sale on the ledger to reverse, a state that forbids the step) is refused with a plain reason and recorded on the audit trail as a failed attempt. The order's page keeps Refunded so far and Still owed to shopper totals.

43. Audit trail (administrators)

/Admin/Audit is the store's administrative memory: who did what, to which record, and when.

- What is recorded - every shop decision (approved, rejected, suspended, reinstated), every order status change staff make, every return decision, received-goods entry, refund issued and every refund attempt that failed, and every payout created, marked failed or reversed. Failed attempts are kept.
- What a row says - timestamp, actor, a dotted action (shop.approved, refund.failed, payout.reversed), the subject as entity type plus id, and a one-sentence summary written by the action itself.
- Filter by action, entity type, entity id or actor; the suggestion lists come from the data. Each shop row on the shops page links to this page pre-filtered to that shop.
- Export the filtered view as CSV or Excel (up to 500 rows).

The trail is append-only and references are deliberately loose (a name string and a numeric id, not foreign keys) - deleting an account or a row never rewrites the history that mentions them. It is also written best-effort: a failing audit write is logged, never allowed to undo the action it was documenting.

44. Payout outcomes (administrators)

A payout is Paid, Failed or Reversed. While it is still Paid, staff can mark it failed (with the bank's reason) or reverse it (recorded in error). Either action releases every entry it covered back to the unpaid balance so the shop can be settled again, while the payout row keeps its totals - a statement is corrected by another row, never rewritten. Both actions are guarded, audited, and shown to the vendor with the reason and the handler's name.

The payout destination (account name, bank, IBAN) is recorded per shop - collected at registration, editable by the vendor on their payouts page, visible to staff on the shop list. The shop is emailed when a settlement is recorded against it (when it has a contact email on file).

Part 4 — Configuration and demo data

Key settings (`appsettings.json`)

Setting	Default / notes
Store:Theme	1 (Amazon), 2 (eBay), 3 (Etsy), 4 (Midnight & Gold). Currently 4.
Store:TaxRate	0.11 (11%). Used when a product has no tax class.
Store:FlatShippingRate	4.50; free above Store:FreeShippingThreshold (60.00).
Email:Enabled / Transport	true / File (writes .eml + .html to App_Data/outbox).
Email:MaxAttempts	4, with exponential backoff.
Payments:Provider	simulator (card payments move no money).
Payouts:MinimumAmount	0.00 (no minimum by default).
Images:MaxBytes / MaxPerProduct	5 MB / 10 images.
Database:Provider	Sqlite by default; switch to SqlServer by configuration.

Demo accounts

Role	Email	Password
Administrator	admin@libanpost.example	Admin#12345
Customer	customer@libanpost.example	Customer#123

Vendors are created by registering a shop at `/Vendor/Onboarding/Register`; staff approve them. The demonstration store is also seeded with approved shops you can sign in as.

Known limitations

- Email is written to files, not sent — nothing reaches a real inbox until an SMTP host is configured.
- Card payments run through the bundled simulator — no money moves.
- Only the storefront chrome is translated (English / Arabic / French); product content and the admin area are English only.
- Payouts are recorded, not transferred — there is no banking integration.
- No currency conversion; a single currency per store.
- The application log table grows until retention is configured (`Logging:Database:RetentionDays`).

Support

For operator and developer detail — architecture, configuration reference, database providers, payments, logging, deployment constraints and the full feature inventory — see the project's `README.md` and `docs/FEATURES.md`.

End of guide.